

Alabama Learning Hour

Ava Goes to Livingston, Talking about where you're going, Future

March 31, 2026

1 Text

Avak Liwistifon Ałłahchi

Ava Goes to Livingston

Alabama.

Avak mobilan waliichik stałłahchi. Nakson ałłahchĩ? Oolafa ałłahchi. Naksi oolafa ałłahchi? Liwistifa ałłahchi. Ołalo okkichon. Matthews-Park-ka-fa chiyahlila, mooton ilakomaylilo okifa. Ischoopafan ałłala. Yalaaha choopala. Ava intaatak tilkon choopalan banno. Mooton łikala. Isafon ilalo okkichon. Mooton intaatak paspispoyatli talboolilo. Cham-pohlilo!

English.

Ava begins to drive her car. Where is she going? She is going to the town. Which town is she going to? She is going to Livingston. She will arrive soon. She will walk in Matthews Park, then she will swim in the water. She will go to the store. She will buy oranges. Ava's dad wants her to buy flour. Then she will head back. She will be home soon. Then her dad will make frybread. It will be good!

2 Vocabulary

Nouns

mobila	car
oola	town
Liwisti	Livingston
oki	water
yalaaha	orange
tilko	flour
iisa	house
taata	father

Verbs

waliichi	drive (a car)
staŋa	start
oŋa	arrive
chiyahli	walk
ilakomayli	swim
choopa	buy
banna	want
ŋika	return
ila	arrive
talbooli	make (food)
champohli	be sweet

Other

okkichon	soon
mooton	then

3 Asking and Answering Questions: *Where is Ava walking?*

- Now that you know how to ask basic questions, you can practice asking people more complicated questions; for example, “What are you doing?” “Where are you going?”
- Questions that use words like *what*, *when*, *where*, *why* are called *wh*-questions in English. Alabama has these too, but they don’t usually start with *wh*!
- Today we will learn one of these words: ‘where?’ — **naksifon**

Asking ‘Where questions’ Easy Recipe

Option 1: [**naksifon** + (**Agent-k**) + **Verb** + **Tense**]

- (1) naksifon + Ava-k + chiyahli + hchĩ
where Ava walk ing?
naksifon Avak chiyahlihchĩ?
‘Where is Ava walking?’

Option 2: [(**Agent-k**) + **naksifon** + **Verb** + **Tense**]

- (2) Ava-k + naksifon + chiyahli + hchĩ
Ava where walk ing?
Avak naksifon chiyahlihchĩ?
‘Where is Ava walking?’

Let’s Practice! *How would you ask this in Alabama?*

- (3) *ilakomayli* - to swim
a. naksifon **Avak** **ilakomayli**-hchĩ? Where is Ava swimming?

- | | |
|---|--------------------------------|
| (4) <u>chokkooli (one person) - to sit</u> | (7) <u>bitli - to dance</u> |
| a. Where is Ava sitting? | a. Where is Ava dancing? |
| (5) <u>hachaali (one person) - to stand</u> | (8) <u>hinakahli - to wait</u> |
| a. Where is Ava standing? | a. Where is Ava waiting? |
| (6) <u>chiyahli - to walk</u> | (9) <u>choffi - to jump</u> |
| a. Where is Ava walking? | a. Where is Ava jumping? |

Answering ‘Where’ Questions

- In English, when we want to answer these kind of questions, you can use the preposition *to*.
- (10) I am going to the store.
- Alabama doesn’t have prepositions like English does. But it does have a special **locative marker** that tells us where something happened at, where someone is going to, or where someone is coming from.
- (11) anok ischoopasi-fon aŋa-li-hchi.
I store-to go-I-ing

Answering ‘where questions’ Easy Recipe

[Agent-k + Place + -fon + Verb]

- (12) a. **Avak** + **ischoopasi** + **-fon** + **bitlihchi** =
Ava store at/to/from is.dancing =
Avak ischoopasifon bitlihchi.
‘Ava is dancing at the store.’
- b. **Avak** + **abohli** + **-fon** + **chiyahlihchi** =
Ava forest at/to/from is.walking =
Avak abohlifon chiyalihchi.
‘Ava is walking in the forest.’
- c. **Avak** + **okichoba** + **-fon** + **ilakomaylihchi** =
Ava lake at/to/from is.swimming =
Avak okichobafon ilakomaylihchi.
‘Ava is swimming in the lake.’
- d. **Avak** + **Dalaska** + **-fon** + **aHahchi** =
Ava Dallas at/to/from is.going =
Avak Dalaskafon aHahchi.
‘Ava is going to Dallas.’

Example Location words

• iisa ‘home/house’	• okichoba ‘lake’	• bokkochaaha ‘mountain’
• ayahchihka ‘gar- den’	• ischoopasi ‘store’	• Dalaska ‘Dallas’
• abohli ‘forest’	• ischoba ‘church’	• Yosti/Houstonka ‘Houston’

Let's Practice! *Pick a verb, and ask your partner where Ava is doing something. Then answer where she is doing it!*

- (13) a. Person 1: naksifon Ava-k bitli-hchĩ?
 where Ava dance-ing?
 Where is Ava dancing?
- b. Person 2: iisa-fon (Ava-k) bitli-hchi.
 house-at (Ava) dance-ing
 Ava is dancing at home.
- (14) chokkooli (one person) - to sit
- a. Where is Ava sitting? (18)
- b. Ava is sitting _____.
- (15) hachaali (one person) - to stand
- a. Where is Ava standing? (19)
- b. Ava is standing _____.
- (16) chiyahli - to walk
- a. Where is Ava walking? (20)
- b. Ava is walking _____.
- (17) bitli - to dance
- a. Where is Ava dancing?
- b. Ava is dancing _____.
- (18) hinakahli - to wait
- a. Where is Ava waiting?
- b. Ava is waiting _____.
- (19) choffi - to jump
- a. Where is Ava jumping?
- b. Ava is jumping _____.
- (20) ilakomayli - to swim
- a. Where is Ava swimming?
- b. Ava is swimming _____.

4 Future Tense (if time)

- There are a lot of ways to express the future tense in Alabama, but we will cover just one of them here
- Recall that we can express present tense using **hchi** and past tense with **-ti** or **-hchõ**.
- Now we will learn how to express the future tense. This time, instead of **-hchi**, **-ti**, or **-hchõ**, the morpheme we will be using here is **-lo**
- We're almost done, but there's one more important thing we need to keep in mind
- Normally, the first person singular agent marker is **-li**, as seen below in (21):

(21) **bitli-li-ti**
 I dance-d

- However, this **-li** becomes **-aa** when combined with **-lo**
- Therefore, we say 'I will dance' as follows:

(22) **bitl-aa-lo**
 I will dance

- One important thing to notice is that the final vowel of the stem gets deleted.
- **Bitli-aa-lo** is a bit awkward to say, so we just say **bitl-aa-lo** instead
- Otherwise, we conjugate the verb as normal, just making sure to put **-lo** in the tense slot in our template
- **Be careful!** Before you conjugate the verb, make sure you know whether to conjugate it using agent agreement or patient agreement!

Let's practice!

(23) bitli - to dance

- a. I will dance.
- b. Ava will dance.
- c. The children (*poskoha*) will dance.

(24) chiyahli - to walk

- a. I will walk.
- b. Ava will walk.
- c. The children (*poskoha*) will walk.

(25) afaaka 'to laugh'

- a. I will laugh.
- b. Ava will laugh.
- c. The children (*poskoha*) will laugh.

(26) (i)stonafayli 'to faint'

- a. I will faint.
- b. Ava will faint.
- c. The children (*poskoha*) will faint.

(27) choffi 'to jump'

- a. I will jump.
- b. Ava will jump.
- c. The children (*poskoha*) will jump.

(28) hinakahli 'to wait'

- a. I will wait.
- b. Ava will wait.
- c. The children (*poskoha*) will wait.